

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 6

COLORADO

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Colorado's family courts and child-welfare system.

129

COLORADO FAMILIES ON RECORD · 215 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 18 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 30, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
33 OF 64

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · COLORADO

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Colorado. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Kimberly B. Schutt

JUDGE · WELD COUNTY · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"The court's permanent orders rewarded obstruction and parental alienation rather than protecting and restoring the father-child relationship. Despite repeated evidence of denied phone calls, withheld parenting time, gatekeeping, scheduling conflicts placed over parenting time, and lack of cooperation from the mother, the Court still awarded her sole decision-making authority over medical, education, therapy, extracurricular activities, and major parenting decisions. The Court relied heavily on historical domestic violence allegations even after the permanent protection order was denied and replaced with only a mutual limited-contact order, using those same allegations to justify denying equal parenting time and joint decision-making. The Court also criticized the lack of family therapy while ignoring that a restraining order and communication barriers made family therapy difficult to initiate, and that the children's therapists and related recommendations were not meaningfully considered. AppClose communications were used against the father despite his efforts to document concerns professionally, while the mother's withholding, interference, and controlling behavior were largely minimized. Independent third-party witness testimony, subcontractor financial records, therapist concerns, and corroborating statements were discounted or ignored, while the Court accepted the mother's narrative with little accountability placed on her conduct. The result was reduced parenting time, removal of midweek parenting, sole decision-making to the parent creating barriers, and financial orders built on un-supported credibility findings rather than balanced evidence and the best interests of the children."*

> *"Was extremely new to family court and not well versed in high conflict parenting. Opened a CPS case falsely using educational neglect as a way to start a CPS investigation that lasted 4 years and thousands of dollars."*

> *"She ignored Family First and listened to DHS."*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/co-kimberly-b-schutt/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

COLORADO AT A GLANCE.

Across 129 Colorado families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST	WENT PRO SE
215	**$232,000**	**18**	**59.7%**
129 of 129 families reported child counts	median across 62 families reporting 3+ categories	of parenting time	77 of 129 who answered; 52 of 129 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
129	1.7	129 of 129	33

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Colorado families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF COLORADO FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	73	$45,000	$105,303	$7,687,089
Lost Wages	59	$30,000	$188,331	$11,111,510
Other Court Fees	54	$2,000	$16,280	$879,133
Therapy / Evaluations	57	$3,500	$10,616	$605,120
Reunification Services	39	$2,000	$6,358	$247,979
GAL Fees	40	$2,500	$8,640	$345,600
Asset Loss [1]	61	$65,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (62 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$232,000	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($65,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost	18	1.5 yrs
Mean months lost	32	2.7 yrs
Total across all families	2,967	247.2 yrs

04 WHO IS REPORTING · COLORADO

Most families documenting in Colorado are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	61	47%
Case closed: within last 2 years	24	19%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	15	12%
Not provided	15	12%
Active case: progress being made	7	5%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only	57	44%
Both Family Court and CPS	49	38%
CPS Only	12	9%
Unknown	11	9%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	46	36%
3 – 5 years	23	18%
5 – 10 years	18	14%
Over 10 years	17	13%
Less than 6 months	10	8%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access	33	26%
Visitation Only	33	26%
50/50 Joint	27	21%
Full Custody	22	17%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)	6	5%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

El Paso	16	14%
Weld	15	13%
Arapahoe	14	12%
Douglas	8	7%
Pueblo	7	6%
Jefferson	6	5%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	43	33%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	24	19%
High Conflict Divorce	18	14%
Other	12	9%
Environmental/Poverty-Related (Lack of housing, utilities, etc.)	7	5%

05 PARENT VOICES — COLORADO

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Colorado comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *Magistrates are on the take in Colorado, to become a judge. If you report misconduct or Brady violations they retaliate on you. CPS is a joke, they all use their in house counsel to solve issues and are connected with other attorneys. Attorneys are notified if CPS is called or [...]*
>
> — COLIN

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

It has destroyed my family and taken my children away from me without any evidence I did anything wrong.

— COLORADO PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM COLORADO

Reinforced the abuser"s control. Now he can do it legally. He has not been held accountable to the fullest extent and I fear my daughter and I will end up dead and then they will say, "there were signs." The trauma done to my daughter and I has stolen health and happiness.

— SELENE

The system has destroyed my son. ,my Family my life my finances, and my local welding business .,My son was ripped away from his aunt ,brothers, cousins, community , friends and school and me his father, and moved 540 miles away. All based upon false allegations ,and proven lies [...]

— KENNETH

I went to family court for help and protection. What I got was a place where my abuser was encouraged and applauded for continuing to abuse me- from smear campaigns, false allegations, and pure punishment. Our judge should be ashamed of himself that he allowed this horrific post [...]

— MAE

They destroyed my hole family and have stolen child support funds ordered to be paid to us by the courts

— PAMELA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Destroyed myself and children for a lifetime. My daughter's both have PTSD, severe anxiety and depression. My son has reactive attachment disorder and Severe Intellectual disability resulting in possibility of never being able to live on his own. My daughter now 15 refuses to [...]*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

My case has been twisted for years. And there is another mother of his children in CO who just lost her lawyers, due to the enormous amount of cost in six months. The judge is allowing him to not submit documents and going off his word, without proof. The judge just ruled in my [...]

— COURTNEY

For over 14 months, my sons' futures have been treated as collateral damage in a scorched-earth strategy where a "childlike" need for control has replaced actual parenting. What is being called "maternal security" is actually a calculated act of deception. This "single mother" [...]

— JUSTIN

CPS was not there to help even after repeated reports of abuse and DV. The court still allows the children time with their abusive father even after findings of abuse, coercive control and DV was made. The court is allowing legal and financial abuse to continue as well as [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated and destroyed siblings bonding and growing up together. Traumatizing children and retraumatizing the adult who was abused by vindictive adopted parents.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has traumatized my kids and myself in ways that I believe are irreparable

— CHARLENE

Family court is where the Constitution of the United States is best used to wipe ones ass, Judges and attorneys know it, lies and false accusations are normal and truth does not matter.

— MIKE

I am a protected party in the state of Colorado on a felony DV case. My abuser has been able to use the judicial system as well as local police and authorities to violate my rights and my daughters in order to continue psychological abuse. My child and I have exhausted [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed and traumatizing

— DAYNA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *It has tried to put fear into me and my children as well as deprive us of our rights. With no help from Gals or Caseworkers they keep you in a state of conformity to benefit themselves.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

Iraq Registered Nurse lost everything, homeless veteran Colorado, scorched earth for catching my wife cheating twice. Met famous comedian Steve Byrne, two months after Iraq tour, told him "Get your tongue out of my Wife's mouth"! Four months later caught her again with another [...]

— PATRICK /PETE

They have destroyed my whole family. And have taking what little faith I had in humanity a flushed it down the toilet.

— DAVID

It took my son days after just turning 2 years old and traumatized him who is special needs and kept him from me. Took almost all our assets forcing sales or me ex selling without permission. Forced to share medical records even though it's illegal.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Lied, manipulated , and legally stole my child, who had already been traumatized. They put my child back in harms way, they took my child and left me helpless no thought of reunification, the entire time they were working for the man who assaulted my child. They were well versed [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I no longer have a family, divorced my ex and she took the kids with the help of the courts and the judge.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Weld County CPS is full of bad actors and corruption. A literal threat made by a caseworker to myself, "I am the end all, be all of this case. "

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Robbed my children of their childhood and connection with their mother for 5 years. Provided them with childhood trauma.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Freedom of speech doesn't exist with CPS. I sent an email asserting my parental rights, then I lost everything that I love in this world. 12 straight years of being a single father-did not matter

— SAMUEL

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *This system didn't just separate me from my children—it took years of love, connection, and memories we can never replace.*
>
> — ALYSSA

It's destroyed me inside and out.

— KASSY

I have lost everything due to the system and how it treats fathers. Child support alone has kept me homeless fkr a decade of my life despite me working full time. The system incentivizes conflict and separation of families without regard for who it's hurting. The judges and [...]

— JASON

Legalized abuse. Kidnapped and tortured childhood and parenthood. Created everlasting trauma for child and safe parent. There truly are not words. Humanitarian Crisis for profit. Pure Evil.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed us and caused trauma and damages for our future

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system failed my children and protected a narraccist mom

— ANDREW

Stripped me of my title as a mom

— MIRANDA

Stolen my son, violating rights to safety and love for both of us. I waited to be a mom, and didn't want to miss any of it but now I'm prevented from all and he's in a home of horror.

— MARY

These proceedings have fundamentally changed my life and my children's lives. I have experienced the loss of substantial parenting time and attachment with my children, significant emotional distress including a CPSTD diagnosis, financial hardship, post separation abuse and the [...]

— OLIVIA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *Family court has helped these evil people steal my children and keep them from me for a good part of almost 7 years when I am an exceptional mother and this has been so traumatic for all 3 of my children and myself.*
>
> — CANDICE

Put me in jail, emotionally traumatized me and my daughter, and had to start my life completely over from scratch.

— CHRIS

In my opinion my ex's law enforcement status has caused DHS to put my children in danger to protect his image.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My family was torn apart by decisions we believe ignored critical evidence, restricted our ability to be heard, and prolonged our separation from our children."

— CRYSTAL

The system has failed me, cost me a lot of money and time with my children

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The first judge was amazing and saw him as the monster he was. They postponed until he retired. The next judge was horrible and gave 50/50.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Derived the children and I of a loving and nourishing relationship. It weaponized the court system against us.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Reunification specialist reunited my trust in court actors and completely ruined how the system was supposed to protect the children and their rights. This has completely torn me away from my children as well as other loving family members and friends.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I asked for help n lost everything instead

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

80 Colorado parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 42 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — COLORADO

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Colorado families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> Magistrates are on the take in Colorado, to become a judge. If you report misconduct or Brady violations they retaliate on you. CPS is a joke, they all use their in house counsel to solve issues and are connected with other attorneys. Attorneys are notified if CPS is called or reported to and investigations are shut down. Police records have been deleted and IA had to be conducted in order to solve the issue of deletion; however no actions were taken in our cases. Douglas and Arapahoe County had to be separated so they couldn't shift their magistrates and judges to hide them from their Brady violations. They is a huge network of broken system thugs that are here for the money but not best interest of your children. CFI, PREs are a joke. PRE sexually assaulted another, lied and abused its power and the county called him a reputable firm and to not talk about him in that disrespectful manner. Zero continuity in cases with magistrates where if they screw up or realize they have been lied to they leave your case, I've been through 15 magistrates and one judge. In the end the system is a joke, politicians want you to know they care but they don't protect your kids and most philosophy's are in place not laws to protect children. Look up divorce marketing magazine, where you see professionals share their testimony's prior to court to gain business from other attorneys. Hard to take down a fraudulent billion dollar business plan supported by politicians because they are the ones appointing the magistrates from property law.
>
> — COLIN

> Reinforced the abuser"s control. Now he can do it legally. He has not been held accountable to the fullest extent and I fear my daughter and I will end up dead and then they will say, "there were signs." The trauma done to my daughter and I has stolen health and happiness.
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>
> — KENNETH

> I went to family court for help and protection. What I got was a place where my abuser was encouraged and applauded for continuing to abuse me- from smear campaigns, false allegations, and pure punishment. Our judge should be ashamed of himself that he allowed this horrific post separation abuse which left me and our 3 children unhoused and bankrupt.
>
> — MAE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

They destroyed my hole family and have stolen child support funds ordered to be paid to us by the courts

— PAMELA

Destroyed myself and children for a lifetime. My daughter's both have PTSD, severe anxiety and depression. My son has reactive attachment disorder and Severe Intellectual disability resulting in possibility of never being able to live on his own. My daughter now 15 refuses to see a counselor for depression for extreme fear of CPS after what they did to her. My oldest daughter now 19, still struggles with trust issues and trusts no counselor. CPS has harassed me every year since coming home over false accusations which has resulted in us never being able to heal or move past the past. Now my kids constantly worry what and when will be next this year.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My case has been twisted for years. And there is another mother of his children in CO who just lost her lawyers, due to the enormous amount of cost in six months. The judge is allowing him to not submit documents and going off his word, without proof. The judge just ruled in my case without even pretrial, based on his accusations. My kids are being subjected to manipulation, trauma, and harm because the courts won't do their job according to the law.

— COURTNEY

For over 14 months, my sons' futures have been treated as collateral damage in a scorched-earth strategy where a "childlike" need for control has replaced actual parenting. What is being called "maternal security" is actually a calculated act of deception. This "single mother" act is a fraud; she hasn't been left alone—she has intentionally forced the father out to prioritize her own emotional grievances. She has kept this case open for 14 months by perpetually manufacturing new "safety concerns" every time the old ones are proven false, stalling any hope of progress to protect her own image. My reactive responses are not the cause of this conflict; they are the direct result of having the truth suppressed for an entire year. She carries this on because she would rather burn the whole house down than engage in the self-reflection and growth required to provide a stable home. To admit the truth now would be to admit she spent a year traumatizing her own sons for a personal vendetta while dismissing her own destructive behavior. The reality is simple: I am not a threat to my sons, and I am not a threat to Elizabeth. I am only a threat to the narrative she has built. You don't protect your children by erasing their father; you protect your own ego by erasing the truth, even if it means destroying the very foundation they were supposed to stand on.

— JUSTIN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

CPS was not there to help even after repeated reports of abuse and DV. The court still allows the children time with their abusive father even after findings of abuse, coercive control and DV was made. The court is allowing legal and financial abuse to continue as well as coercive control and mental abuse through family therapy and visits. Children's rights, wishes and best interests are not followed but instead the abuser gets rights while his victims are scrutinized.

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— MIKE

I am a protected party in the state of Colorado on a felony DV case. My abuser has been able to use the judicial system as well as local police and authorities to violate my rights and my daughters in order to continue psychological abuse. My child and I have exhausted financials in a legal battle to prove and speak our truth. This system is broken. We need immediate action and intervention as well as law enforcement training on pattern recognition in DV spanning 1-3years. All reported. True victims deserve to be heard, not silenced by the ones who are sworn to protect.

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It's destroyed me inside and out.

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I have lost everything due to the system and how it treats fathers. Child support alone has kept me homeless fkr a decade of my life despite me working full time. The system incentivizes conflict and separation of families without regard for who it's hurting. The judges and magistrates that enable these things should be made to forfeit their places to live despite the contents of their bank accounts to see how it feels. Its unforgivable to hurt children and loving parents for personal profits and state revenue. Disgusting.

— JASON

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

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These proceedings have fundamentally changed my life and my children's lives. I have experienced the loss of substantial parenting time and attachment with my children, significant emotional distress including a CPSTD diagnosis, financial hardship, post separation abuse and the constant demands of navigating multiple court proceedings, all while continuing to comply with services and advocate for my relationship with my children.

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I and my kids cannot visit my mother in law who is too old to come visit us. They have robbed them of their grandmother because if we go back they certainly will remove them from my care. My attorney wants me to challenge the system and return. Ha! No. Id rather live at peace in exile than in agony back in Colorado. I've lost alot of my property I had to leave behind because of them. It's crushing but I have what matters most my kids because I took my babies and ran. Colorado knows that I was deemed innocent of all charges they still want me to rot for 17 to life. Although procedurally they were forced to drop the warrant. They fully intend to continue the case if I go back. This has caused me permanent loss in wages as my career I could make more money there than I can in Ohio.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They've torn us apart and impacted our family in a very traumatic and or traumatized both my child andvmyself!!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was a former DHS staff member who exposed cover-ups of deaths of 7 children and covered-up kidnappings 2008-2021 in Pueblo County. I have the EEOC charges and unpublished recordings of closed door meetings, including one with now ex-Mayor, who was an law partners who shared practice with DHS attorney.

— MICHELLE

I never thought I would grieve the life of a deceased child, let alone my living children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court has completed destabilized myself and my two children. It is devastating and I'm still dealing with the grief of the aftermath.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Ripped is apart, tortured our son, drowned him to silence him, then continued kidnapping my kids in efforts to break my spirit and discredit me to avoid accountability for drowning Jayden. They keep taking my kids without reason but the fosters who drown Jayden never lost their biological kids for it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

A lawyer who has repeatedly made false accusations, with no evidence.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Colorado courts are a cesspool of misconduct and corruption. The states private attorneys/lawyers are completely unethical. Both treat Colorado's own state constitution, Colorado Supreme Court precedent, and federal supremacy as optional, in fact they completely disregard and despise them. They have completely destroyed my family and relationship with my sons. These people are criminals.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My wife has stage 4 cancer and they removed her child on the childs birthday. The system is using caregiving as an excuse for neglect.

— CLAYTON

Destroyed my relationship with my child and enabled my abuser to continue abusing myself using the system as their tool. Have suffered irreparable physical, mental, and financial harm.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Used the system to take the one thing that would hurt me to lose.

— AMANDA

The system destroyed my family and now as my adult daughter still deals with the repercussions to this day, I know something needs to be done now to stop this!

— AMANDA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Torn us apart. Lack of due process nearly destroyed a close relationship between mother and son

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

REMOVE MAGISTRATE AND JUDGES IMMUNITY SO THEY CAN BE HELD ACCOUNTABLE AS THEY HAVE CAUSED MY GRANDDAUGHTER AND DAUGHTER IRREPARABLE DAMGE BOTH PHYSICALLY AND MENTALLY.

— FRANKLIN

The system left me living in a camper while rewarding the man who harmed us, and taught my daughters to value resources over safety.

— JULIE

Denied justice due process and it cost me everything. Now I feel like I'm being harassed by child support.

— MARK

Major health complications from three years of scorched earth litigation; daily harassment and harm by my abuser. Because no one held him accountable, he's now suing me for $10 million in a fake defamation case.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Currently family members are all being lied to and about.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system has only brought torment and trauma and fear to my son, and I. My son at only 4 years of age, has fear of being taken away from his Mommy. And I have fear in taking my son to things that are supposed to be the most normal and helping situations such as a hospital, but instead, I have only fear and anxiety.if anything happens that might need hospital assistance. As a mother, I should only have to think of Making my child better. And shouldn't have to second-guess, bringing him to the hospital if needed because of how they make me feel. And the trauma that it's caused

— KRISTEN

They have threatened mine and my family's life for speaking out. Elite families with their boot on our necks. Deplorable behavior and multiple CPTSD "diagnosis. Loss of property-financial abuse, stalking, theft, intimidation. MENACING to the fullest extent. Has foster care "mom" 🙃

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

We live in a country which would rather sell children than pay a living wage, and Fathers are in line behind strangers to raise their own flesh and blood, which means my daughter is now the property of a pedophile, under a banner of Christianity, while I starve to death in a welfare motel, making it impossible for me to get her back, and implausible that I will live long enough to tell her I didn't "give" her to anyone, if she lives.

— COLIN

This situation has affected our daughter and her siblings relationship which should never happen with Family First in place.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son (and daughter, in a separate case) were torn away from me based on completely untrue allegations made by my vindictive ex. It cost me the first 5 years of my sons life, cost me 4 years of my young daughters life, but the cost to my kids has been severe childhood trauma, and it is insurmountable.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system continues to show me that it is all about the money who has it who can pay more. The best interest of children is not at the forefront of the court.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This family court rewarded parental alienation, restricted my relationship with my children, and gave sole decision-making authority to the parent creating barriers to our bond, despite evidence of withheld parenting time, denied contact, and gatekeeping. At the same time, it imposed financial orders based on unsupported income assumptions that created impossible obligations, pushing me into debt while weakening my ability to remain a stable and present father in my children's lives.

— ANDREW

The system tried to kill me and erase my from my child's life. My ex manipulated my own family and tried to get them to testify against me as harshly as possible so as to do th most damage that he possibly could. My son was only three years old and was ripped away from me. I was a stay at home mom for most of his life by that point. I had only just begun to go back to school and work when my ex and I separated. My son was still breastfeeding and my mother and grandmother do not act in good faith, they covertly chose to side against me because my ex had the money. My mom secretly also was trying to take my son for her own even though that was never even up for discussion. Also my mom's boyfriend at the also testified against me as a police officer because he was mad I didn't let my mom borrow my car to visit him in the middle of the night during a snowstorm. My reliable vehicle was my only way to get to and from work at the time so I could pay my attorney fees and I could not let her take it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It's made me feel like I'm not a Good Mother. Even though I know I do my best as a Single Mother. It's Harassing me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated us,.... Lives and memories lost,... Its affected my health tremendously Iv always thought they placed her with Unsafe people they have a criminal background and guns in there homes I put photos in my book the missing that shows photos of my daughter near guns they have other kids also near guns and weaponry,.....

— LINDSEY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Complete destruction of ability to thrive, depleting my parents retirement savings, extreme constant stress to child, me, my parents my siblings and their children. Straining and diminishing any/all meaningful relationships as this is too much for anyone close to hear in detail, but it's our entire life.

— AUBREE

Taking my daughter as an infant, when her father was absent. Not taking breastfeeding seriously, or developmental needs. Ignoring doctors and specialists. Ignoring evidence of substance use around child and witness testimony.

— JANELLE

The Magistrate belittled me for an hour at the last hearing. Threatening to take my child away from me because I wasn't "flexable". All because I was following the court order. No where can anyone show me a law or state statute that mandates me to be flexible instead in leu of a court order.

— KELLEY

The system is built on, whoever makes the loudest accusations or has the most money I came to court with timeline, documented evidence, and proof of competence... it was dismissed and I was restricted even after proof through DHS clearing me NO FINDINGS.

— EVELYNN

it has ruined my family's dynamic, we used to be close and now all of us have a form of ptsd and are experiencing that in the courts. we do not trust these caseworkers to ever do their jobs properly.

— PRISCILLA

This system tore my family apart based on unproven allegations, damaged my relationship with my child, and forced us to endure lasting emotional and financial harm. Even after the case was dismissed without an adjudication, my family was left to carry the trauma caused by the people and institutions that were supposed to protect us.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> Caused physical, emotional, and psychological harm because I'm too disabled to work and have no funds to hire an attorney and thus have to represent myself which is impacting my health and could permanently lower my "baseline" (making me more disabled than I was before getting divorced) and opposing counsel is weaponizing my disabilities against me and disregarding my real limitations because she doesn't THINK I'm as disabled as I say I am.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Removed my kid, now they are trying to terminate my right for failed to complete treatment. But they don't do anything to help me. Just help placement and cause me more pain and suffering.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I have to come back to this; right now I'm gearing up to try to modify our case and I have to stay in a place of anger instead of sadness because I will simply crumble. I cannot crumble right now. I have a lot to say and will send a better answer when I can mentally handle opening that door.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Thank you doing you job and insureing my child wer safe my home and my ex's. Partner callses really helped him do better and stop blaming other for his short coming. None of it would have been possible without the child protective services.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

80 full approved Colorado comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Colorado report comes from Colorado respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Colorado — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 129 Colorado families reporting here are not the universe of Colorado families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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